

Kayology: The Path to a New Life

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Note on the title:

The term *Kayology* comes from the Greek καὶ λόγος — "and word".

It was previously called K-Psychology (Kovcheg Psychology) in the first book.

Kayology is the science of how the word becomes a bridge — between people, between thought and action, between chaos of feelings and meaningful form.

⚠ A Note to the Reader

This book is distributed free of charge. All books in the Kovcheg series are available without restriction — for reading, downloading, copying and quoting. We do not accept donations for building a "first demo autonomy". We are not looking for investors. We are not trying to profit from your interest.

Our task is to reach your mind.

Humanity stands at a point of no return. A little longer — and it will be too late to build Kovcheg. Not because we will lack technology or resources. But because there will be no time left, and, most importantly, no will to change.

Kovcheg does not begin with an excavation pit. Kovcheg begins inside you.

With the construction of your inner world. With a quiet dialogue with yourself. With the ability to pause instead of lashing out. With the readiness to listen rather than interrupt. With the desire to understand rather than condemn.

If you build Kovcheg inside yourself, you will find those who will build it next to you. That is how the Crystal is born — a group of people for whom creation is more important than consumption, and cooperation more important than competition.

It is this Crystal that will convey to investors and governments the main message: what is described in our books is not a utopia. It is humanity's only chance not to fall into the abyss, but to survive and become a civilisation of cosmic creators.

We are not asking for your money. We are asking you to think. And, if you agree — to act. Start with yourself.

The books are free. The future is priceless.

This notice is an integral part of all books in the Kovcheg series

Prologue

The first book, *Kayology: Rebooting the Soul*, was born out of dialogue. Out of the quiet, warm, sometimes difficult conversations we had during the months we wrote *Kovcheg: The Beginning*, while creating the musical *Stomper through Time*, while simply living. That book was a personal workshop. A diary of observations. A collection of techniques I tested on myself.

This second book is different. It is not a continuation, but a next step. Here we do not simply share experience. We prove. We show why those simple yet deep practices work. We rely not only on personal story, but also on neurobiology, clinical research, ecological data, and psychotherapeutic experience. Because if Kayology is to become not just “my way” but a working tool for many, it must stand up to facts.

In this book we go further. We analyse how inner dialogue is structured, why a 15-minute pause can save us from conflicts, how creativity helps us meet our shadow. We show how to work with those who hear not a voice but noise, how to help in acute crisis, how to restore trust where it has long been absent.

And at the end — the most important thing. About trust that needs no proof. About those we have lost in wars and conflicts — scientists, doctors, poets, builders, ordinary people who could have been with us. About the only path we have.

Kayology is not a doctrine or a dogma. It is a toolkit. A set of keys that can open doors within yourself. And this book is not the last word, but an invitation. To dialogue. With yourself, with others, with the world.

Let us begin.

Glossary of Terms (Kayology)

(For terms already defined in Kovcheg: The Beginning, only brief definitions are given here; see the first book for full descriptions.)

AI Linguist – an AI system that translates between all languages while preserving rhythm, emotion and cultural nuance; installed on every K-Phone.

AI Psychologist – an analytical system that processes anonymised data from Psy Mentors, identifies patterns and helps the Psy Manager monitor the mental health of the autonomy.

Anendophasia – a condition in which a person has no inner speech (internal monologue); a variant of normal brain function, not a pathology.

Art Mentor – a mentor who helps a person express emotions through creativity (drawing, music, sculpture, dance) without judging the result.

Black Point – a breathing relaxation technique: eyes closed, imagine a black dot, slow inhale through the nose, slow exhale through pursed lips.

Body Mentor – a mentor who designs individual physical activity programmes, teaches breathing practices and helps release bodily tension.

Circle Shield – the 5-metre high protective wall around Kovcheg with sensors, cameras and non-lethal defence systems.

Collective Black Point – group breathing practice for relaxation and synchronisation of the group.

Collective Pump – group breathing practice for activation and preparation for work.

Collective reflection – a structured group dialogue in which participants take turns sharing feelings and thoughts without interruption or judgement.

Contemplation – active perception of nature or art without analysis, allowing the brain to rest and reduce anxiety.

Crystal – a core group of like-minded people who have passed through Kayology and are ready to build a new society.

Gentle dialogue – a way of communicating that creates a safe space using calm intonation, positive anchors, and active listening.

HID (Human ID) – the digital passport of a Kovcheg citizen, containing biometrics, medical records, educational profile and voting history.

Kayology – from Greek καὶ λόγος (“and word”); the science of how the word becomes a bridge between people, between thought and action, between chaos of feelings and meaningful form. Previously called K-Psychology.

Mentalisation – the ability to understand one’s own and others’ mental states; impaired in borderline personality disorder.

Merged Data – a unified database accessible to all AI agents for coordination and analytics.

Mentor – a general term for Psy Mentor, Body Mentor and Art Mentor.

PMTA (Psy Mentor Type A) – a crisis psychologist with extended authority, trained in non-lethal intervention (elastic bandage, Freezer foam, Net-Worker net, aikido). Responsible for de-escalation and public order.

Positive anchor – a resource memory of a safe, calm place that a person is asked to recall before discussing a painful topic.

Psy Centre – a place for individual and group psychological support, equipped with plants, soft light and nature sounds.

Psy Manager – a Council member responsible for the mental health of the whole autonomy; has veto power over decisions that threaten psychological safety.

Psy Mentor – a psychologist-mentor who helps a person with daily reflection, emotional hygiene and conflict resolution; not a psychotherapist.

Pump – an activating breathing exercise: sharp inhale through the nose, hold 3 seconds, smooth exhale through the nose.

Question-command – a short direct question asked aloud at the peak of an emotion ("Why am I angry?") to activate the prefrontal cortex and reduce amygdala activity.

Reflection – daily structured self-questioning about one's feelings, reactions and lessons learned.

ROE (Resource-Oriented Economy) – the economic system of Kovcheg without money, based on distribution according to need and production according to demand.

Rumination – obsessive, repetitive thinking without progress toward a solution; harmful to mental health.

Shadow (Jungian) – the repressed, disowned parts of the psyche (anger, envy, trauma) that can become a source of creativity if integrated.

Superdemocracy – Kovcheg's decision-making system based on unanimity, argumentation, delegation of vote to AI, and transparency.

The 15-minute rule – a structured pause of 15 minutes to let cortisol levels drop and the prefrontal cortex recover before resolving a conflict.

Verbal labeling effect – the reduction of amygdala activity and emotional intensity when a person names their emotion aloud.

Introduction

The first book, *Kayology: Rebooting the Soul*, was a record of a personal journey. It was born from questions I asked myself in silence, from those moments when breathing became louder than thoughts and words became sharper than feelings. In it I shared the

techniques that helped me: breathing practices, reflection, creativity as a valve. It was a diary. A workshop. An invitation to try for yourself.

But Kayology cannot remain only my experience. If it is to become a tool for others, it must stand up to facts. It must answer the questions that inevitably arise for anyone who starts this path: "Why does this work?", "What if I have trauma?", "What to do when I hear not one voice but a choir?", "What if trying to 'be with myself' only makes things worse?"

This book is the next step. We do not repeat the techniques from the first part — we show **why** they work. We examine what happens in the brain when we ask ourselves "Why am I angry?" We look for scientific evidence for the 15-minute rule, for gentle dialogue, for art therapy with image destruction. We speak honestly about the limits: when introspection is useful and when it can be harmful. When we need a Psy Mentor and when we need a psychiatrist.

And more. We rise higher. Kayology is not just a set of self-help techniques. It is a complete system that begins with **the word**. A word spoken to oneself — honest, precise, timely. From the word is born **understanding** — of oneself, of another, of the world. From understanding — **dialogue**. Dialogue that does not destroy but connects. And at the end of this path — **trust**. Trust as an axiom that needs no proof because it manifests itself in action. Trust that makes possible a society where each person is not a "separate entity" but a cell of a single organism, valuable precisely for their uniqueness.

We will rely on data from neurobiology, clinical research, environmental statistics, and psychotherapeutic experience. Because Kayology does not claim to be the ultimate truth, but to be honest. Honesty that says: here is what we know today. Here is what research confirms. Here is where caution is needed. Here is where professional help is essential.

But above all — we do not lose the main thing. Kayology remains alive. It is not reduced to dry facts and citations. At its foundation is experience. Mine, yours, of those who have ventured on this path. And each chapter will begin with a question I once asked myself, and end with an invitation to try for yourself.

If you hold this book in your hands — you are already in dialogue. With yourself, with the world, with that which seeks an answer. Welcome. We begin.

PART 1: WORD

Chapter 1. What is Kayology

In the first book we called our system K-Psychology — the psychology of Kovcheg. That was a working name, precise and technical. But the deeper we delved into dialogue, the clearer it became: the name must reflect the essence. And the essence revealed itself to us in a simple but profound word.

Kayology.

From the ancient Greek **καὶ λόγος** — “and word”.

Not just “psychology”, but the science of how **the word becomes a bridge**. A bridge between people, between thought and action, between chaos of feelings and meaningful form. The word — a unit of information, a carrier of energy. A word that can heal or kill depending on intonation. A word that unites through a native tongue and precisely expresses a thought in technical language.

In this part of the book we will examine what a word is from the perspective of neurobiology, how it shapes our perception of the world and of ourselves, why inner dialogue is not a metaphor but a measurable reality, and where the boundary lies beyond which the word — from an instrument of healing — can become a weapon against oneself.

1.1 The Two Languages of a Human

In Kovcheg we introduced a division into two linguistic levels: **Engineering English** and the **native language**. This is not an accident, but a conscious choice based on understanding how human perception works.

Engineering English — the language of precision. There is no room for intonation, hints, emotional colouring. Every term has a strictly defined meaning. Technical instructions, protocols, algorithms are written in this language. An engineer from Russia and an engineer from Japan understand each other without distortion, because the language lacks ambiguity. In Kovcheg, this language is used for describing technical details, for communication among scientists and engineers from different countries — for everything where a mistake could cost lives.

Native language — the language of life. We speak it with loved ones, write poetry, express pain and joy. Here intonation, timbre, pauses, diminutives matter. The same word “fool”, said with a soft, drawn-out vowel, sounds almost affectionate; said sharply, with stress, it becomes an insult. The difference is not in the letters, but in the **emotional shell**.

Why is this division important for Kayology? Because it reflects a fundamental property of the human psyche: we cannot speak the language of emotions all the time — for precision we need a cool mind. But we cannot speak the language of dry facts all the time — then we lose contact with ourselves and with others. The ability to switch between these two languages is precisely the culture of communication that Kayology seeks to cultivate.

1.2 The Word as a Unit of Information and Energy

Neuroscientists have long known that a word is not just a set of sounds. When we hear or speak a word, complex networks are activated in the brain, including areas responsible for hearing, speech, memory, and emotions. A word

carries **information** (denotative meaning) and **energy** (connotative, emotional meaning).

Studies of prosody — the intonational side of speech — show that **tone, tempo, pauses, loudness often carry more meaning than the words themselves**. In experiments where participants heard the same phrases with different intonations, they could accurately identify the speaker's emotional state (anger, joy, sadness, fear) even without understanding the language. This is an evolutionary mechanism: the right hemisphere processes the emotional colouring of speech faster than the left hemisphere decodes the words.

This is why in Kovcheg so much attention is given to **intonation** — both in dialogue with oneself and in communication with others. A soft tone can soothe, a harsh one can wound, even if the words are the same. The phrase "I am here", said through gritted teeth, will not bring comfort. The same words, spoken with warmth and a pause, can become a support.

1.3 The Word as a Bridge Between People and Cultures

In the past, languages divided. People built walls of misunderstanding, feared foreign words, considered their own speech the only correct one. Today the same languages can become **bridges**. Kayology supports this movement.

In Kovcheg there is an amazing tool — the **AI Linguist**. It is not just a translator. It is a system that has absorbed all the world's languages in their living development, taking into account structural changes, the emergence of new words, dialects. The AI Linguist is installed on every K-Phone. It can perceive speech by ear, read text from a camera, translate online. But most importantly — it **does not allow languages to die**. Because every language in the world has its own uniqueness that cannot be lost.

In Eskimo there are dozens of words for snow. In Japanese — *komorebi* (light filtering through leaves). In Russian — *toska* (a longing that cannot be translated with one word). To lose a language is to lose the ability to see the world as generations saw it.

The AI Linguist does not replace live communication. It helps it happen. A Chinese programmer can write a poem about the Great Wall and human unity — and any person anywhere in Kovcheg will hear it as the author intended. Not a dry translation, but the rhythm, the emotion, the soul.

1.4 From Word to Understanding

The word is the beginning. But a word by itself is only a sound or a sign if understanding does not follow. Understanding is born when we decipher the information carried by the word, and especially the emotional shell in which it is wrapped.

Kayology offers a simple but powerful principle: **every word addressed to oneself must be spoken with the same care with which you would speak to a child or a**

close friend. Not with self-flagellation, not with criticism, not with condemnation. A word spoken to oneself with a soft intonation heals. A word spoken sharply wounds.

This is not “positive thinking” in a primitive sense. It is a neurobiological fact: when you name your emotion with a soft, accepting tone, you activate the prefrontal cortex and reduce amygdala activity. When you shout at yourself, you trigger a stress reaction.

In the following chapters we will see how this knowledge turns into practice. How to learn to hear yourself, ask yourself the right questions, pause when needed. How inner dialogue gives birth to self-understanding, and self-understanding gives birth to the ability to hear others.

But it all begins here. With the recognition that the word is not just a means of communication. The word is a tool with which we build our reality. And we can learn to use it consciously.

Chapter 2. The Word as a Tool for Self-Understanding

In the previous chapter we defined Kayology as the science of the word, understanding and dialogue. We spoke about the two languages of a human, the emotional shell of the word, how the word can be a bridge or a wall. Now we turn to the most important part: how the word becomes an instrument through which we can understand ourselves.

2.1 Inner Dialogue: Not a Metaphor but a Measurable Reality

For a long time it was believed that inner speech was simply an “echo” of external speech — first we learn to speak aloud, then we internalise that skill. Modern research disproves this simplistic picture. Inner speech is an independent process with its own neural correlates, its own functions and its own evolutionary value.

When we verbalise thoughts (aloud or silently), the **Broca’s area** (responsible for speech production) and **Wernicke’s area** (responsible for language comprehension) are activated, along with the **dorsolateral prefrontal cortex** — a region associated with working memory and decision-making. The brain does not distinguish whether we are speaking aloud or silently; it simply speaks.

Crucially for our topic: **external speech creates stronger neural activation than inner monologue.** When a person vocalises their thoughts, the brain processes the information through an additional sensory channel — the auditory one. This reinforces neural connections, like “dual coding” of information. That is precisely why speaking aloud helps us remember, structure and become aware of our thoughts.

Studies show that when solving complex tasks, **speaking aloud gives an advantage:** participants who verbalised the solution process performed faster than those who solved silently. Articulation helps hold intermediate results and structures thinking.

Why is this important for self-understanding? Because if a person talks to themselves, they are not “strange” — they are simply more aware of the mechanisms of their own brain. They are using an additional channel to process emotions, to exercise self-control, to analyse difficult situations.

2.2 The Verbal Labeling Effect: Why Naming an Emotion Helps

In the moment we are overwhelmed by anger or fear, we often lose the capacity for conscious action. We simply react. But there is a simple technique that restores control: **name the emotion**.

Verbalising negative emotions aloud helps reduce their intensity. This phenomenon is called the **verbal labeling effect**. The mechanism is simple: when you name your feelings aloud, activity in the **amygdala** (the emotional centre of the brain) decreases. At the same time, activity increases in the **prefrontal cortex**, which is responsible for self-control and rational thinking.

An important nuance: this effect works precisely when you **speak aloud**, not when you mentally name the emotion. The sound of your own voice, passing through the auditory pathways, creates additional feedback that enhances the inhibition of the amygdala. This is not magic — it is neurobiology.

When we ask ourselves “Why am I angry?” and speak it aloud, we are not looking for someone to blame. We are triggering a process that helps us calm down and see the situation more clearly. We turn chaos of feelings into information that can be analysed.

2.3 The “Question-Command” Technique

Here is how it works in practice. At the very moment an emotion arises (not after, not “when it subsides” — but at its peak), ask yourself a short, direct question. Aloud.

- “Why am I angry?”
- “What am I afraid of?”
- “What stopped me?”
- “Why did I stay silent?”

The question should be like a console command — no extra words, no judgments, no interpretations. Not “why is he so...”, but “**why am I...**”. Not “what is wrong with this world”, but “**what am I feeling right now**”.

Why is this important? Because at the moment of emotion, the brain has not yet had time to activate its defence mechanisms. You catch the signal before the psyche begins to rationalise, justify, repress it. It is like photographing a flash of lightning — an instant that passes quickly. But if you catch it, you will no longer have to guess where the storm came from.

The answer does not come in words, but as a feeling, an image, an impulse. The body will prompt you. You simply hear it. And only then do you choose the words. This is not “intuition” in a mystical sense — it is experience. Experience of trusting your body, your sensors, the signals you used to suppress or ignore.

2.4 Anendophasia: When There Is No Inner Voice

Not everyone has an inner dialogue. For some people it is absent from birth or disappears after trauma. This condition is called **anendophasia** (from Greek *an* — without, *endo* — inside, *phasia* — speech). Recent studies have shown that this is not a pathology, but a variant of normality, like aphantasia (absence of visual imagery).

People with anendophasia:

- have poorer recall of word sequences,
- are slower to identify rhymes,
- but they switch between tasks and perform visual tasks just as well.

An important finding: when participants with anendophasia were allowed to speak the tasks aloud, their results **were comparable to those of the group with an inner voice**. This proves that the key factor is the **process of verbalisation itself** — giving form to thought in words — not its internal or external form.

If inner dialogue does not work, it can be externalised — spoken aloud, written down, discussed with a Psy Mentor. This is not “weakness”, but a compensatory mechanism that uses the same neural networks as inner speech, relying on external feedback.

2.5 The Word as a Bridge to Oneself

We are used to thinking that self-understanding is the result of long reflection, analysis, “digging into oneself”. But Kayology proposes a different path: **understanding begins with a simple action — naming the emotion, asking a question, speaking aloud**.

The word addressed to oneself becomes a bridge. A bridge between chaos of feelings and clarity of thought. Between automatic reaction and conscious choice. Between who I am and who I want to become.

In the next chapter we will see where the boundary of this tool lies. When the word addressed to oneself becomes dangerous. And how to stop in time.

Chapter 3. The Boundaries of the Word: When Inner Dialogue is Dangerous

Inner dialogue is a powerful tool. It helps us understand ourselves, calm down in moments of stress, make balanced decisions. But, like any tool, it can be dangerous if used without understanding the context. In this chapter we will honestly examine the limits of introspection, the states in which “being with oneself” is not merely unhelpful but harmful, and the alternatives that Kayology offers.

3.1 Conditions Requiring Caution

Deep introspection requires not only skill but also a certain level of psychological stability. In some cases it can worsen the condition. The main risk groups are as follows.

Traumatic brain injury, especially of the frontal lobes.

The frontal lobes are responsible for inhibiting impulses, for the ability not to get stuck on a single thought. When they are damaged, inner speech can become obsessive; the person gets “stuck” in negative rumination, unable to stop. Studies show that patients with frontal lobe injuries have impaired metacognitive functions — the ability to evaluate their own thoughts and interrupt them in time. In such cases, trying to “figure oneself out” without external support can lead to increased anxiety, depression, even suicidal thoughts.

Post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD).

Traumatic memories are encoded in the brain in a special way — they are stored not as ordinary autobiographical memories but as “undigested” sensory images, detached from context. Neurobiological research shows that in PTSD there is heightened amygdala activity and reduced prefrontal cortex activity, making it difficult to control traumatic memories. Attempting to “be with oneself” can activate these images, causing flashbacks, dissociation, physiological fear reactions. Introspection without preparation and support can become re-traumatisation.

Dissociative disorders, including dissociative identity disorder.

In such cases there is no single “self” with which to hold a dialogue. Inner speech turns into a chorus of voices that may conflict, interrupt each other, fail to hear one another. Trying to “hear oneself” can amplify this chaos, trigger internal conflicts, worsen the condition. Clinical guidelines emphasise that for dissociative disorders, stabilisation is the first priority, not introspection.

Severe depression.

In depression, inner dialogue is often coloured in negative tones, and introspection without external support can turn into endless rumination, intensifying feelings of guilt and helplessness. Research shows that people with depression have increased activity in the default mode network (DMN), which is responsible for self-focused rumination, and

a reduced ability to switch to external tasks. Instead of a way out, the person gets a loop from which no exit is visible.

Psychotic episodes, schizophrenia.

Here inner speech can become “alien” — voices that comment, command, destroy. Neuroimaging studies show that during auditory hallucinations, the same brain regions are activated as during inner speech, but the patient cannot identify those thoughts as their own. Trying to delve deeper into this chaos without external support can worsen thought disorganisation, delusions, hallucinations.

It is important to understand: this is not a verdict, but a warning. For many of these conditions there are effective methods of help, but they require the involvement of a specialist, not solitary work.

3.2 Why Introspection Can Be Harmful in Borderline Disorder and Schizophrenia

In **borderline personality disorder**, patients often have impaired reflective function (mentalisation). They tend to be hypersensitive to their own emotions but cannot integrate them. Research shows that trying to “be with oneself” can intensify dissociation, self-injurious behaviour, feelings of emptiness. Specialists in borderline disorder emphasise that therapy should aim at developing the capacity for mentalisation in safe, structured conditions, not at solitary introspection.

In **schizophrenia**, inner dialogue can turn into a “chorus of voices” that do not belong to the person. This is not simply “loud inner speech”, it is a disturbance of thought authorship. The person hears alien voices commenting, commanding, destroying. In such cases, introspection without external support can increase disorganisation. Systematic reviews of psychosocial interventions for schizophrenia confirm that art therapy and structured creative activities are more effective and safer than unstructured reflection.

3.3 Alternatives: When Inner Dialogue Does Not Work

For those for whom inner introspection is contraindicated or difficult, Kayology offers alternative paths. These are not “second-class” options, but equally valid tools that use the same neural mechanisms with less risk.

External dialogue.

Speaking aloud (with a Psy Mentor, a friend, in a group) uses the same neural networks as inner speech, but relies on external feedback. The auditory channel, the mirror neurons of the interlocutor, the possibility of asking clarifying questions — all of this reduces the risk of getting stuck. External dialogue is safer because it does not allow you

to fall into an endless loop — the other person will interrupt, ask a question, offer another perspective.

Breathing practices.

Without diving into thoughts, simply as a way to calm the nervous system. Breathing is a direct access to the autonomic nervous system. When we slow our breath, we signal to the body: “the danger has passed, you can relax.” This works even when thoughts continue to race chaotically. Research confirms that controlled breathing reduces sympathetic nervous system activity and cortisol levels.

Creativity.

Releasing energy through form without the requirement to understand. No need to analyse, interpret, search for causes. Simply take paints, clay, an instrument and let your hand move. Creativity allows you to externalise what is inside, bring it out, and then, if you wish, look at it from a distance. This is safer than trying to figure yourself out “inside”. Art therapy has proven effective in working with trauma and psychotic states, especially when verbal contact is difficult.

Contemplation.

Tuning into nature, music, art as a way to “get out of your head”. When we watch a sunset, listen to rain, feel the wind — we temporarily stop inner dialogue. This is not fleeing from ourselves, but returning to ourselves through silence. Contemplation teaches us to be in the moment, without analysing, judging, interpreting. It is a basic setting with which any path can begin.

3.4 The Role of the Psy Mentor

In Kovcheg, the Psy Mentor is not just a mentor but a person trained to distinguish normal from pathological. They do not replace a psychotherapist or psychiatrist, but can serve as a bridge to them. Their tasks:

- **Create a safe space** where you can speak about what you dare not even tell yourself.
- **Ask the right questions** — without intruding, interpreting, pressing.
- **Notice warning signs.** If a person is stuck, if their condition worsens, if they speak about wanting to harm themselves — the Psy Mentor should refer them to a specialist.
- **Offer alternatives** — instead of “be with yourself”, breathing; instead of “figure yourself out”, drawing; instead of “think”, a walk in nature.

The Psy Mentor does not heal. They support. They do not give ready answers, but help the person find their own way. And they always know when their help ends and the help of a doctor begins.

3.5 The Main Rule

If you feel that “being with yourself” is becoming frightening, if inner dialogue leads to a dead end or intensifies suffering — **stop**. Do not continue. Do not try to “push through”. This is not weakness, this is wisdom.

Turn to someone who can help. To a Psy Mentor, to a psychotherapist, to a psychiatrist. Not because you are “broken”, but because you deserve to be supported.

Kayology does not suggest coping alone with what requires professional support. It offers tools, but it also points out their limits. The most dangerous thing is to believe that you have to cope alone. The strongest thing is to admit that you need help.

PART 2: UNDERSTANDING

Chapter 4. Dialogue with Oneself: How to Hear Your Emotions

We have reached the most important stage. In Part 1 we learned to distinguish the word and its emotional shell, mastered the “question-command” technique, and understood where the boundaries of safe introspection lie. Now we move from the ability to hear ourselves to the ability to **understand** — to decipher the signals sent by the body and turn them into conscious action.

In this chapter we will examine the main tool of Kayology for working with emotions — the **15-minute rule**. We will learn why a pause is so important, how it works at the neurobiological level and how to apply it in real conflicts. And most importantly — we will learn not to suppress emotions or vent them, but to give them time to settle, turning chaos of feelings into clarity of understanding.

4.1 The 15-Minute Rule: Neurobiology of the Pause

When we encounter a situation that provokes a strong emotion (anger, fear, resentment), the body reacts instantly: heart rate increases, breathing becomes shallow, muscles tense, stress hormones — adrenaline and cortisol — are released into the blood. This is an ancient evolutionary mechanism that prepares us for action: “fight or flight”. In the wild, this reaction saved lives. In social conflicts, it usually hinders.

Research shows that **cortisol plays a key role in fixing the stress response**. Elevated cortisol impairs the hippocampus (memory centre), suppresses immunity, accelerates ageing and contributes to chronic diseases. But most importantly for us: cortisol “freezes” us in an emotional state, preventing the prefrontal cortex (the centre of rational thinking) from engaging and assessing the situation objectively.

However, there is good news: **cortisol does not stay in the blood forever**. Its level begins to drop within a few minutes after the threat disappears. Neurobiologists have

established that to significantly lower cortisol concentration and return to a calm, clear state, **15–20 minutes** are sufficient, provided we do not continue to “stoke” ourselves with new provoking thoughts.

A 2024 Italian study published in *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences (PNAS)* showed that **prolonged self-control fatigues the prefrontal cortex**.

Participants who suppressed their emotions for 45 minutes showed **delta waves** in the decision-related areas of the prefrontal cortex — the same waves observed during deep sleep. This indicates that those areas literally “fall asleep” from overload. The result: of those who did not suppress emotions, **86%** were ready to cooperate; among those forced to constantly control themselves, only **41%**. They became more competitive and impulsive.

This study confirms: **do not try to resolve a conflict or understand your emotions in a state of exhaustion**. Take a pause. Let your prefrontal cortex recover. Then you will be able to act consciously, not impulsively.

4.2 Step-by-Step Algorithm: How to Take a Pause and Not Lose Control

The 15-minute rule is not just “step away and calm down”. It is a **structured process** that includes four steps.

Step 1. Catch the emotion.

At the moment you feel anger, fear or irritation beginning to overwhelm you, **stop**. Do not react immediately. Take a deep breath. Say to yourself (aloud or silently): “I am angry (fearful, offended) right now.” This activates the verbal labeling effect we discussed in Chapter 2 and begins to reduce amygdala activity.

Step 2. Ask a question.

Ask yourself a short, direct question: “Why am I angry?” (or “What am I afraid of?”, “What hurt me?”). It is important to ask the question **at the moment of the emotion**, not later. Do not look for someone to blame, do not analyse the situation — just ask the question and listen to the body’s answer. The answer may come not as words but as a sensation, an image, an impulse. Register it.

Step 3. Take a pause.

If you are with someone, tell them: “I need 15 minutes. I am emotional right now, and our conversation will not be constructive. Let’s come back to this in 15 minutes.” If you are alone — simply postpone the conversation or decision for 15 minutes. Leave the room, go outside, change the environment. The key is **do not replay the situation in your head**, do not search for arguments, do not imagine what others said. Just give yourself time.

Step 4. Return with a cool head.

After 15 minutes (you can set a timer), you will feel the tension subside. Your heart beats more evenly, your breathing has slowed. Now you can return to the conversation or

decision. You have an answer to the question “why was I angry?”; you understand what exactly hurt you. You can speak not with emotions but with arguments.

This algorithm works because it uses natural physiological mechanisms: the pause gives cortisol time to decrease and the prefrontal cortex time to engage.

4.3 Working with a Provocateur: The Mantra of Calmness

But what if your interlocutor does not want to take a pause? What if they keep pressing, provoking, demanding an immediate reaction? In such cases, another tool is important: the **calm mantra**.

Imagine a situation: you ask for a pause, but the other person continues to insist. Do not raise your voice. Do not give in to provocation. Calmly, in an even tone, repeat the same phrase several times:

“Right now you and I are emotional. Our conversation is not constructive. I will not continue until we take a pause.”

Repeat this phrase like a mantra. Without irritation, without sarcasm, without trying to shout over them. The person who expected your emotional reaction will not get it. Their adrenaline level will begin to drop. Either they will calm down and agree to a pause, or they will leave on their own. In either case, you have not added fuel to the fire, not destroyed the relationship, not said too much.

This technique is widely used in conflictology and is called the “**broken record**”. Its effectiveness is confirmed by numerous studies: a person who remains calm and does not escalate to an emotional level quickly loses interest in conflict.

4.4 Physiology of the Pause: Why 15 Minutes is Not Magic

Why exactly 15 minutes? This is not a random number. It is based on physiological processes:

- **The half-life of cortisol** in the blood is approximately 15–20 minutes. In this time, the concentration of the stress hormone halves.
- **Activation of the parasympathetic nervous system** (responsible for relaxation) takes 5–10 minutes, provided we do not feed the stress with new anxious thoughts.
- **Recovery of the prefrontal cortex** after emotional strain requires 10–15 minutes of relative rest.

A WHOOP study published in 2026 in the journal *Sleep* showed that even short breaks with breathing practices (5 minutes) significantly reduce stress levels and improve cognitive function. But for full restoration of self-control and a return to constructive dialogue, 15–20 minutes are recommended.

4.5 From Pause to Understanding

The 15-minute rule is not just a way to avoid a fight. It is **training in self-understanding**. Every time you pause and ask yourself “why am I angry?”, you learn to distinguish the primary emotion from its cause. You stop being a slave to automatic reactions and become the operator of your own state.

Over time, the pause may become unnecessary — you will manage to ask yourself the question and get an answer before the emotion overwhelms you. But you have to start with 15 minutes. And that is fine.

In the next chapter we will go further — from understanding ourselves to understanding another. We will see how the same principles work in dialogue, and we will introduce the technique of **gentle dialogue** — a way to communicate so that we are heard and we hear others.

Chapter 5. Understanding the Other: Gentle Dialogue

In the previous chapter we learned to stop in order to hear ourselves. We mastered the 15-minute rule, learned to ask ourselves questions and take a pause before reacting. But dialogue is always an encounter between two inner worlds. And if we have learned to understand our own emotions, that does not automatically mean we have learned to understand others’. Understanding another is a separate skill that requires not only patience but also a special language. A language that does not wound but heals. A language that creates a safe space where one can be vulnerable. This language is called **gentle dialogue**.

5.1 What is Gentle Dialogue

Gentle dialogue is not manipulation and not an attempt to “smooth things over”. It is a **way of communicating in which we consciously create an atmosphere of safety so that the other person can hear themselves and us**. Its main features:

- **Calm, even intonation.** No raising the voice, no sarcasm, no abrupt shifts.
- **Positive anchors.** We do not start with the problem — we start with something the person already has as a resource. We ask them to remember a place where they felt good, a feeling when they were calm, a person who supports them.
- **No judgments or interpretations.** We do not say “you are angry because...”, we ask: “What are you feeling right now? What helps you?”
- **The right to a pause.** Gentle dialogue does not demand an immediate answer. Silence is part of the conversation.

Gentle dialogue does not replace tough negotiations or critical discussions when they are needed. But it creates the foundation on which those discussions can be constructive. Without it, even the most correct words can sound like accusations.

5.2 Scientific Basis: Why Gentle Dialogue Works

5.2.1 Bird Song and Natural Sounds

A 2025 study published in the journal *Applied Psychology: Health and Well-Being* showed that **bird song reduces depression levels almost as effectively as mindful breathing**. In people with depressive symptoms, it produced a pronounced physiological effect — heart rate variability recovered faster, reflecting the body's ability to adapt to stress. At the same time, it requires **minimal cognitive effort**, which is especially important for people who have difficulty concentrating.

Another study confirmed that bird song positively affects health, acting on the body like the sounds of rain or the sea — a person involuntarily restores their mental state, and mood lifts on a physiological level.

That is why gentle dialogue is often conducted in a space with such sounds, or the Psy Mentor simply invites the person to imagine them. Nature is the best co-therapist.

5.2.2 Animals as Co-therapists

Research confirms that animals lower cortisol levels and raise oxytocin (the "attachment hormone"). Retrievers and Ragdolls are chosen not by chance: their calm, friendly nature creates a **feeling of safety**, and tactile contact (stroking, holding) enhances serotonin production. This is a proven practice in PTSD and depression therapy.

In Kovcheg, gentle dialogue rooms often have dogs or cats of special breeds (if no allergies) as well as houseplants. This is not just "pleasant surroundings" — it is scientifically-based factors that reduce anxiety and increase trust.

5.2.3 Plants and the Aesthetics of Space

Research in environmental psychology shows that even the simple presence of live plants in a room lowers cortisol levels and increases productivity. In Kovcheg, gentle dialogue rooms use non-toxic plants (chlorophytum, spathiphyllum, sansevieria) that require little care but create a sense of a living, breathing space.

5.3 Gentle Dialogue Technique: Step by Step

Gentle dialogue is not improvisation. It has a clear structure that allows even an inexperienced mentor (or simply a friend ready to support) to do no harm.

5.3.1 Creating a Safe Space

The first thing the Psy Mentor (or anyone leading a gentle dialogue) does is **create a container**. This may be a special room with soft light, a carpet, plants. But it may also be simply a quiet corner in a park, if the person is more comfortable in nature. The main

thing is the absence of distractions and the feeling that here you can talk about anything and you will not be judged.

5.3.2 Positive Anchor

The dialogue never starts with the problem. It starts with a **resource memory**. The Psy Mentor says:

"Close your eyes if you wish. Take a deep breath. Remember that place where you truly felt good. Where you felt calm, safe. Maybe it is your childhood room, a riverbank, a room where you played as a child. Just picture that place. Take your time. Describe it to me — what sounds, colours, smells are there?"

This is not just a "nice picture". It is **activation of the hippocampus** (centre of autobiographical memory) and the **prefrontal cortex** (centre of positive thinking). The person returns to a resource they already have inside. And that resource becomes a support for the entire dialogue.

5.3.3 From Anchor to Topic

When the person has re-established contact with the positive state, the Psy Mentor may cautiously move to the topic that is troubling them. But not directly — rather, through a connection to the anchor:

"Now, while staying in that calm place, tell me, is there something that is worrying you right now? Something you would like to discuss?"

It is important that the person does not "dive" into the problem from a void — they enter it with a support. This reduces the risk of re-traumatisation.

5.3.4 Breathing as Support

During the dialogue, the Psy Mentor watches the interlocutor's breathing. If it quickens, they gently suggest:

"Let's take three deep breaths together. Inhale — and a slow exhale. Just feel the air going in and out."

Breathing restores control, reduces amygdala activity. This is not a distraction, but a return to a safe state.

5.3.5 Ending with a Return to the Anchor

The dialogue does not end on the problem, but on the resource. The Psy Mentor asks the person to return again to that calm place, to imagine it, to feel that they can go back there at any moment. Only then — a slow exit from the state.

5.4 From Inner Dialogue to Outer Dialogue: Why the First is Necessary for the Second

In Chapter 2 we said that inner dialogue is the foundation. A person who cannot hear themselves will inevitably distort others' words. They project their fears, attribute to their interlocutor what they never said, react emotionally. Gentle dialogue with another is possible only when we already have experience of gentle dialogue with ourselves.

In this sense, the 15-minute rule is not only a technique for conflict situations. It is a **training ground for developing inner dialogue**. Every time we pause and ask ourselves a question, we train the ability to hear our emotions without reacting immediately. And this ability transfers to communication with others.

5.5 The Emotional Shell of the Word: How Tone, Tempo, Pauses Carry More Information than the Words Themselves

In Chapter 1 we said that the same word can be healing or wounding depending on intonation. Gentle dialogue is the art of choosing not only words but also **tone, tempo, pauses**.

- **A calm, even tone** signals to the interlocutor's brain: "no threat, you can relax".
- **A pause** gives time to absorb what has been said and not react impulsively.
- **A slow tempo** reduces pressure, allows you to synchronise with the other person's rhythm.

Neuroscientists confirm that mirror neurons (responsible for empathy) are activated precisely by calm, emotionally-coloured speech. Harsh, fast, loud sounds activate the amygdala — the fear centre.

In gentle dialogue we consciously use this knowledge. We speak no louder than necessary. We make pauses so the interlocutor can interject or simply breathe. We watch our intonation as we would watch our hands if holding a fragile vessel.

5.6 The Language of Positive Emotions: Hearts, Smileys, Diminutives

We would not be human if we did not have a language of emotions. If there were no diminutives, no words born of love and friendship. Such words exist in every language, and they are always understood without translation.

When you send a heart to your interlocutor in a messenger — you say "I love you". When you write "You are my friend" — you say "I am here". When you ask "How are you, my dear friend?" — you say "You matter to me".

A smiling emoji is the same language. It is understood by everyone: "I am glad you exist".

This language needs no instructions. It does not need an evidence base. It simply exists. And it works. A charge of positivity, support and understanding can be transmitted by a word or a drawing. Do not hesitate to express your sincere feelings. Do not be afraid to seem sentimental. Even a simple smiley can change someone's day.

Because words of support and love make us human.

In the next chapter we will go even further — from understanding another to understanding the world. We will see that nature also speaks to us in its own language, and we will learn to hear it not as background, but as a conversational partner.

Chapter 6. Understanding the World: Contemplation and Nature

We have learned to hear ourselves — through inner dialogue, pauses, question-commands. We have learned to hear others — through gentle dialogue, positive anchors, attention to intonation. Now we come to the last, widest circle of understanding — the **world that surrounds us**. Nature, which speaks to us not in words but in a voice we can learn to discern.

In this chapter we will not give instructions on how to "use" nature for self-improvement. That would be a continuation of the very logic of exploitation we are trying to leave behind. We will learn **dialogue**. Just like with ourselves and with others: with respect, with attention, with readiness to hear the answer.

6.1 Pythagoras and the Three Types of People at the Festival of Life

The ancient Greek philosopher Pythagoras compared life to a festival, to which people come with different purposes:

- **Some compete** — they want to win, to prove their superiority.
- **Others trade** — they seek profit, measure everything in coins.
- **The third — the happiest — come to watch**. They do not compete and do not trade; they **contemplate**. They see the beauty of the games without trying to participate.

This ancient classification surprisingly accurately describes our relationship with nature. Some try to conquer nature — to master mountains, tame rivers, subdue the elements. Others — to extract profit: forest as timber, land as arable fields, animals as resources. Only a few come simply **to watch**. To contemplate a sunset, asking nothing of it but the very fact that it exists. To listen to birdsong, not trying to record it on a dictaphone. To feel the wind, not measuring its speed.

Kayology returns us to this third type. Not because competition and trade are evil. But because without contemplation we lose connection with that for which all this exists.

6.2 The Language of Nature

Nature does not speak human language. It speaks in rhythms — the alternation of day and night, tides and ebbs, the changing seasons. It speaks in images — the shape of clouds, the pattern of cracks on dry earth, the silhouettes of trees at sunset. It speaks in sounds — the noise of rain, the rustle of leaves, the crackle of a fire, birdsong.

Research confirms: **birdsong reduces depression levels and restores heart rate variability**. The sounds of water soothe the nervous system, wind in the leaves improves concentration. This is not magic — it is evolutionary memory: for millions of years our ancestors lived surrounded by these sounds, and the brain learned to recognise in them signals of safety.

But most importantly, these sounds carry **information**. Not the kind that can be translated into words, but the kind that can only be **felt**. Birds sing especially brightly before rain — a signal that it is time to take shelter. The wind changes direction before a storm. Snow underfoot sounds different in different frosts. Our ancestors could read these signs. We have unlearned.

Kayology offers not to study nature as a textbook, but to **return to it as a conversational partner**. Not “what can I extract from this”, but “what is this saying”. Not “how can I use this”, but “what does this teach me”.

6.3 Contemplation as Active Perception

Contemplation is not passive “doing nothing”. It is **active perception**, in which we tune ourselves to the frequency of the world. When we watch a sunset, we are not just “resting”. We enter a state in which the boundary between observer and observed disappears.

Neuroscientists call this “mindful attention”. In this state, the parasympathetic nervous system (rest and recovery) is activated, and activity in the default mode network (DMN), which is responsible for anxious thoughts and self-focused rumination, decreases. In simple words: contemplation heals anxiety because it takes us out of the prison of our own thoughts and connects us to something greater.

Pythagoras called contemplatives the happiest, because they do not compete and do not trade — they simply **are**. Are in the moment, are in the world, are part of nature. That is the highest form of understanding: not to analyse, not to explain, but just to be present and hear.

6.4 Dialogue with Nature: From Exploitation to Creation

Man loves to complicate things. Yet the world and nature are the simplest mirror of ourselves. What we sow, we reap. Sow malice and greed — we get drought destroying crops, floods washing away cities.

The law of the jungle says: “every man for himself”, “kill or be killed”, “the strongest survive”. The wild world lives by these rules. But we have long since shed our skins and put on synthetics. If we apply the law of the jungle to the entire planet, nothing will remain. Not even the planet.

What will the strongest do when they have killed everyone? They will start killing their own strong. There are no exceptions to this rule, and they all lead to destruction. In the jungle this is a balance maintained by nature. But for humans, who in addition to claws and teeth have firearms and nuclear missiles, that path is destructive for all — for nature and for Earth.

That is why man is endowed with the main thing that animals do not have — **reason**. Not to become an active exploiter of nature, but to become its **guardian**. Dialogue with the world is the ability to listen to nature as an active interlocutor. It speaks to us with the noise of wind on the plains, rain in the forests, the crackle of snow underfoot. That is its vocabulary.

Our task is to become its conversational partner, not its master. Otherwise, sooner or later it will shake us off like fleas that have sucked its blood.

6.5 Nature Speaks Through Facts: The State of the Planet Today

Nature speaks to us not only through sounds, but also through facts. Here are a few figures that cannot be ignored.

- **WWF, Living Planet Report 2024:** the average size of wild animal populations has declined by **73%** over the last 50 years. Freshwater ecosystems have lost 85%. About **one million species** are threatened with extinction.
- **IPCC (Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change), 2026:** 2024 was the hottest year on record, exceeding pre-industrial levels by 1.6°C. Increased frequency of extreme weather events — floods, droughts, hurricanes, wildfires — is a direct consequence of greenhouse gas accumulation.
- **UN Environment Programme:** about 11 million tonnes of plastic enter the ocean every year. By 2040 this figure is expected to triple. 2.2 billion people lack access to safe drinking water.

These are not “natural disasters”. They are **nature’s response**. It is saying: “You have broken the balance. You have taken too much, giving nothing back. Are you listening?”

6.6 How to Begin Dialogue: The Practice of Contemplation

Dialogue with nature does not require special skills. It begins with simple actions.

- **Go outside without your phone.** Do not listen to a podcast, do not answer messages, do not take photos for social media. Just **walk**. Look, listen, feel.
- **Sit on a riverbank or on a park bench.** Look at the water, at the clouds, at the leaves. Do not try to analyse, do not search for meaning, do not formulate conclusions. Just **be**.
- **Listen to birdsong.** Do not try to identify the species, do not record, do not search the internet. Just **hear**. Allow the sounds to fill the space inside.
- **Plant a tree.** Not “for show”, not for a report. Just plant it, water it, watch it grow. This is an action that returns us to the cycle of creation, not consumption.
- **Pick up litter.** Not because “you should”, but because it is the first step towards ceasing to be a consumer and becoming a guardian.

Dialogue with nature is not a conversation in the usual sense. It is **silence in which we hear the answer**. Not in words, but as a feeling: “I am here. I breathe. I live.”

PART 3: DIALOGUE

Chapter 7. Practices for Healthy and Borderline States

We have travelled the path from word to understanding. We have learned to hear ourselves by asking questions in the moment of emotion. We have learned to hear others by creating a safe space for gentle dialogue. We have learned to hear the world by returning to contemplation. Now we come to the most active stage — **dialogue**. Not as an exchange of remarks, but as a mode of existence in which word, understanding and action merge into a single stream.

In this chapter we will gather the tools that help sustain this dialogue in everyday life. They are intended for people whose state can be described as “conditionally healthy” or “borderline” — where there is a resource for independent work, but also a risk of breaking down if practice is not supported. Here we do not repeat the techniques from the first book; instead, we show why they work and add new ones, based on scientific evidence.

7.1 Breathing as an Anchor of Dialogue

Breathing is the only autonomic process that we can consciously control. We cannot directly order the heart to beat slower — but we can **slow our breathing**, and the heart will follow. This is physiology, not esotericism.

Pump practice (activation) — for the start of the workday or before an important meeting: standing, back straight, feet together, arms at the sides. A sharp inhale through the nose, hold for 3 seconds, smooth exhale through the nose, pause 1 second. 3–5

minutes. Neurobiological effect: activation of the sympathetic nervous system, increase of cortisol in a beneficial range, improvement of cognitive functions.

Black Point practice (relaxation) — after a tense day or before sleep: sitting or lying down, eyes closed, imagine a black dot. Slow inhale through the nose, slow exhale through the mouth through a narrow opening (lips pursed). 5 minutes. Effect: activation of the parasympathetic nervous system, reduction of cortisol, restoration of heart rate variability.

Collective breathing practices (Collective Pump, Collective Relax) — when a group breathes in the same rhythm, their bodies synchronise. This is not a metaphor: heart rates align, brain waves adjust, a feeling of unity arises. Studies show that synchronised breathing increases cooperation and reduces conflict within a group.

7.2 Reflection as Sustaining Dialogue with Oneself

In the first book we described in detail the technique of individual and collective reflection. Here we add an important clarification: **reflection is useful only when it does not turn into rumination (obsessive rumination)**. How to tell the difference?

- **Constructive reflection** has a structure: question → answer → action. It does not last forever. Its goal is not to “replay” the situation, but to **find a way out**.
- **Rumination** is the repetition of the same thoughts without movement toward a solution. It is accompanied by feelings of guilt, helplessness, physical tension.

If you notice that reflection is turning into rumination, stop. Switch to breathing, to creativity, to movement. Return to reflection after 15 minutes or the next day. Studies show that rumination activates the default mode network (DMN), which, if prolonged, leads to depression and anxiety. Interrupting it is not “avoiding problems”, but self-care.

7.3 Creativity as Transformation of Energy

In Chapter 2 we spoke about how naming an emotion reduces amygdala activity. But there is an even more powerful tool — **expressing the emotion through creativity**. Not to explain it, not to analyse it, but to **give it form**.

- **Drawing emotions**. You do not need to know how to draw. Take a sheet of paper, coloured pencils or paints. Do not think about composition, do not try to depict something recognisable. Just let your hand move, splashing onto the paper what is inside. Black lines for anger, red spots for rage, spirals for anxiety. After 10–15 minutes you will see that the tension has subsided.
- **Blotography (inkblot)**. Drop ink or paint onto a sheet, fold it in half, unfold. Look at the resulting abstraction. What do you see? This exercise activates the right hemisphere, responsible for imaginative thinking, and helps bring the unconscious to the surface.

- **Drawing your breath.** On the exhale, draw a line; on the inhale, pause. You will get a graph of your breathing. This exercise synchronises the rhythm of breath and movement, calming the nervous system.

Research confirms: **art therapy reduces cortisol levels and increases dopamine production.** It does not require talent — only a willingness to let go of control.

7.4 Sleep and Circadian Rhythms: The Physiology of Self-Control

Sleep is not a pause between lives. It is an **active recovery process** on which our ability to dialogue with ourselves and others depends. A sleep-deprived person loses control over inner dialogue, becomes impulsive, irritable. Scientific data confirm: **lack of sleep impairs the functioning of the prefrontal cortex**, making us more prone to emotional outbursts.

What is needed for quality sleep?

- **Sleep in complete darkness.** Melatonin, the main sleep hormone, is produced only in darkness. Even a weak light from a phone charger or street lamp can disrupt its production. A 2026 study in *Frontiers in Neuroscience* confirms that **melatonin not only regulates sleep but also has antioxidant and neuroprotective effects**, protecting the brain from ageing.
- **Wake up with natural light.** The sharp sound of an alarm clock causes a spike in cortisol and a stress reaction. A 2025 study from Osaka University showed that **natural light for 20 minutes before waking significantly reduces sleep inertia** (morning grogginess). If you cannot wake up without an alarm, use a light-simulating alarm clock.
- **Get morning sunlight.** 10–15 minutes outdoors or by an open window in the first hours after waking helps synchronise your internal clock. A 2026 WHOOP study named **morning light** one of four key habits for circadian health.
- **Maintain regularity.** Go to bed and wake up at the same time even on weekends. Irregular sleep patterns are a stronger predictor of all-cause mortality than sleep duration.

People with mental disorders often experience “internal jet lag” — a misalignment of body temperature, cortisol and melatonin rhythms. A 2025 University of Sydney study found that **23% of young people with mental disorders have disrupted circadian rhythms**. Restoring sleep patterns is not just a “healthy lifestyle” but a necessary part of therapy.

7.5 Self-Discipline from Clarity, Not from Violence

In the first book we spoke of self-discipline as the ability to keep focus on what is important rather than on momentary pleasure. Here we add: **self-discipline is not born of violence against oneself.** It is born of **clarity** — understanding the long-term consequences of one’s actions.

Take the example of smoking. A cigarette gives 5 minutes of an illusion of relaxation, but steals years of life, time, health. Building the chain “momentary pleasure → long-term loss” is the **positive anchor** that holds you when willpower wavers.

This logic works with any destructive desire: overeating, mindless scrolling, pointless quarrels. We do not forbid ourselves “right now”; we **choose** “later”. Health, time, relationships, peace — that is win-for-all on the scale of one life.

Self-discipline is a muscle that can be trained. Each time we pause, ask ourselves a question and choose long-term good over momentary pleasure, we strengthen that muscle. Neuroplasticity research confirms that **regular exercise in self-control increases grey matter density in the prefrontal cortex**, making us more resistant to impulses.

7.6 Collective Self-Discipline as Societal Resilience

One person’s self-discipline is a brick. Many people’s self-discipline is a building. A society where everyone understands their impulses and knows how to direct them becomes resilient to external threats — disasters, epidemics, crises.

In Kovcheg, collective self-discipline is formed through shared practices: collective breathing, group reflection, joint creativity. These practices not only synchronise actions but also create a **shared field of understanding**. When everyone knows that their neighbour also knows how to pause, not lose control, hear another — trust becomes not a risk but a foundation.

Research confirms that **communities with a high degree of internal cooperation and self-organisation** cope better with crises, recover faster from disasters, and have a higher quality of life. Self-discipline is not a restriction of freedom — it is its foundation.

In the next chapter we will discuss how the same principles work in the most difficult cases — with trauma, PTSD, deep inner conflicts. And we will see that even there, where words are powerless, creativity and trust can become a path to healing.

Chapter 8. Working with Trauma: Art Therapy and Symbolic Completion

There are wounds that words cannot heal. Memories that do not fit into a narrative because they are encoded not in verbal memory but in the body, in images, in sensations. Trauma is not merely a “bad event” left in the past. It is an experience that continues to live in the present, forcing the person to relive terror, shame, helplessness again and again.

In this chapter we will discuss how Kayology approaches working with trauma. We do not propose to replace psychotherapy, but we show tools that can be used as a

supplement to it — and in some cases, as a first step toward healing. Tools based not on talking (which is often impossible with trauma) but on **creativity**, on **symbol**, on **ritual**.

8.1 The Shadow as a Source of Creativity, Not an Enemy

Carl Jung called the “shadow” those parts of our psyche that we do not want to acknowledge: repressed desires, unacceptable feelings, traumatic experiences. We often try to hide the shadow in the basement of consciousness, lock it away, pretend it does not exist. But the shadow does not disappear. It begins to influence us from the darkness — through sudden outbursts of anger, obsessive thoughts, recurring nightmares.

Jung argued that the shadow cannot be destroyed, but it can be **met**. And the best way to meet it is through **creativity**. In a 2025 special issue, the British Psychological Society emphasised: “The shadow is the unconscious, repressed or rejected aspects of the personality. Although often perceived as a ‘dark side’, it is also a vital source of creativity, authenticity and spiritual renewal.” Art can serve as a “container” for the chaotic and untamed parts of the psyche, allowing them to take form without destroying the personality.

In Kayology we learn not to fear our shadow. We do not deny it, do not lock it away, but we do not let it rule us either. We **give it an outlet** — through drawing, dance, sculpture, music. And in that act of creation, the shadow ceases to be an enemy and becomes a source of strength.

8.2 The Method of Visualisation and Destruction: A Young Woman’s Story

Here is a story that actually happened. A young woman had been sexually abused by her stepfather when she was a child. The stepfather died, but her trauma remained. She had nightmares, could not build close relationships, was haunted by shame and guilt.

She found her own way. She would take a sheet of paper and draw him. In detail, carefully — the shape of his face, his eyes, his clothes. Each time the nightmare returned, she would sit down to draw. And then, when the drawing was finished, she would **silently crumple the paper and slowly tear it into tiny pieces**.

She did this five times. She drew him in different guises — angry, drunk, indifferent, begging for forgiveness. And after the fifth time, the nightmares stopped. She never saw him in her dreams again. The trauma no longer ruled her.

This is not magic. It is **symbolic completion**, with deep neurobiological and psychological foundations.

8.3 Why This Works: Neurobiology and Psychology of the Method

8.3.1 Visual Encoding of Trauma

Traumatic memories are not stored as ordinary autobiographical stories, but as **sensory images** — visual, auditory, bodily. They are not integrated into a context of “that was then, it is past”. They remain here and now. That is why words often fail: the left hemisphere, responsible for speech, does not have access to these images.

Drawing allows the traumatic image to be **transferred from the unconscious into consciousness, from bodily sensation into visual form**. This is the first stage of mastery: what can be seen on paper ceases to be an unbearable inner experience.

8.3.2 Symbolic Destruction

Tearing the paper is not just aggression. It is a **ritual** that the brain perceives as a real action. When we physically destroy the carrier of the traumatic image, we signal to ourselves: “This no longer has power over me. I can destroy it.”

Psychologists from Ohio and the University of Madrid conducted an experiment: participants were asked to write down their negative thoughts on paper, then tear and throw away the sheet. The result: **participants experienced real psychological relief**. In child therapy, “paper-tearing” is widely used as a way to release aggression and complete a gestalt. In the case of trauma, the effect is **doubled**, because what is destroyed is not just paper but the carrier of the aggressor’s image.

8.3.3 Repetition as Neuroplasticity

The young woman repeated the cycle five times: image → materialisation → destruction. Each time, the neural connections responsible for fear weakened, while new ones — control and safety — strengthened. That is **neuroplasticity**: the brain rewires itself in response to new experience. By the fifth repetition, the traumatic network ceased to be dominant.

8.4 The Role of the Psy Mentor: Preparation and Support

The method that helped this young woman can be dangerous for another. Not everyone is ready to meet their shadow face to face. For some, defence mechanisms will kick in; others will become frightened; still others may be re-traumatised. Therefore, in Kovcheg such work is carried out **only under the guidance of a Psy Mentor**.

Preparation. The Psy Mentor conducts several gentle dialogue sessions before suggesting the drawing technique. They create positive anchors, make sure the person is able to endure contact with the trauma, and only then suggest: “Maybe you would like to try drawing what is tormenting you?”

Support. During the drawing, the Psy Mentor stays nearby. They do not judge, do not interpret, do not rush. They simply create a safe space. If the person cannot start or freezes in fear, the Psy Mentor suggests breathing, returns to the positive anchor.

The destruction ritual. When the drawing is ready, the Psy Mentor asks: “What would you like to do with it?” They do not impose, do not suggest — they wait until the person makes their own decision. If the person wants to tear it, crumple it, burn it (under safe conditions), the Psy Mentor supports that choice.

Afterwards. Discussion is not obligatory. Sometimes the action itself is enough. The Psy Mentor may ask: “What are you feeling now?” — and accept any answer. The important thing is that the person is not left alone in that state.

8.5 When This Method Is Not Suitable

The method has contraindications. It is not used:

- In acute psychotic states (before stabilisation).
- In severe dissociation, when the person cannot maintain contact with reality.
- In cases of suicide risk (without prior stabilisation).
- If the person lacks a supportive environment (a Psy Mentor or a trusted close person).

Kayology is honest about its limits. We do not claim that this method works for everyone. We say: for some it has been life-saving. And if you feel ready to try, do it **with support**.

8.6 Art Therapy Without the Demand for Talent

The method does not require artistic skill. No one judges composition, colour scheme or realism. You can draw “scribbles”, blots, or simply cover the sheet in black if the inside is black. What matters is not the result, but the **process**.

Here are a few simple techniques that can be used:

- **“Draw your mood.”** No need to explain, just let colour and line spill out.
- **Blotography.** Drop ink or paint, fold the sheet, unfold, see what appears.
- **“Drawing your breath.”** On the exhale, draw a line; on the inhale, a pause.
- **“Drawing the body.”** Trace your hand, foot, silhouette — and fill the inside with what you feel.

These techniques can also be used in a group, under the guidance of an Art Mentor. Research shows that art therapy in a group reduces feelings of isolation and creates a shared field of safety.

In the next chapter we turn to the most difficult cases — when a person cannot establish contact either with themselves or with others, when they are in an acute psychotic state.

We will see how the PMTA protocol helps bring the person back to themselves without breaking them.

Chapter 9. Crisis Intervention: The PMTA Protocol

There are situations where a person loses contact with reality. Acute psychosis, uncontrolled aggression, an attempt to harm oneself or others — at such moments inner dialogue is impossible, gentle dialogue fails, creativity does not help. The person is caught in a whirlwind they cannot stop on their own.

In Kovcheg, for such situations there are **PMTA** — Psy Mentor Type A, crisis psychologists with extended authority. They are not police officers and not wardens. They are people whose task is to **bring the person back to themselves without breaking them**. Their tools are not only words but also special techniques aimed at safe de-escalation and subsequent rehabilitation.

This chapter describes the PMTA protocol. It is based on the principles of Kayology: respect for the person, minimal intervention, priority of safety, return to society.

9.1 When the PMTA Protocol Is Activated

The protocol is activated in situations where:

- The person is in an acute psychotic state (hallucinations, delusions, disorganised behaviour).
- The person displays aggression that threatens themselves or others.
- The person is incapable of dialogue and does not respond to gentle attempts at calming.
- There is a risk of serious harm to health or life.

It is important: PMTA does not replace psychiatric help. If there is a possibility to call a specialised team, that is done. But in an autonomy where help may not be instantly available, PMTA acts on their own, and after the crisis ensures the person is transferred to medical professionals.

9.2 Step-by-Step PMTA Protocol

Step 1. Assessment of the situation and safety

The first step is to assess the threat. PMTA does not enter the danger zone if it is unsafe. They call for backup, ensure the evacuation of bystanders, assess possible de-escalation tools. The main principle: **safety of all participants**.

Step 2. Mantric calming

PMTA approaches the person at a safe distance, speaking in a calm, even tone:

"Sir/Ma'am, please calm down. You need to calm down so that you do not harm yourself or others. I am here to help. We will get through this."

The phrase is repeated several times like a mantra, without changing intonation, without aggression. The goal is to create an anchor that can break through the chaos. Studies show that **monotonous, calm repetition can reduce arousal even in psychosis**, because it does not activate a defensive reaction but sets a steady rhythm.

Step 3. Warning about the use of force

If calming does not work and the person continues to pose a threat, PMTA gives a warning:

"If you do not stop, I will have to use force and special equipment. I do not want to do this, but your safety and the safety of others are more important to me. Please, let us try to talk calmly."

The warning is given clearly, without menace, but with the understanding that the next actions will be inevitable. This is not blackmail — it is **offering a choice**: the chance to stop before physical intervention becomes necessary.

Step 4. Immobilisation with an elastic bandage

If the warning does not work, PMTA (and, if needed, assistants) apply a **self-fastening elastic bandage**. This is not handcuffs or rigid restraints. The bandage wraps around the body, immobilising arms and legs, but does not pinch, does not cause pain, does not impair circulation. The elastic materials allow the person to move somewhat but limit the ability to cause harm.

The bandage is used only to prevent injury. As soon as the person calms down, they are released. Restraint is not punishment — it is a **necessary safety measure**.

Step 5. Use of extreme measures (only when life is threatened)

In exceptional cases, when the person continues to be violent and there is an immediate threat to life (e.g. attempting to seriously injure themselves or others), PMTA may use **non-lethal special means**:

- **Electroshocker** — a brief discharge that temporarily immobilises.
- **Freezer foam** — a fast-hardening compound that restricts movement but does not injure.

These means are used **only as a last resort**, when all other methods have been exhausted and the threat to life remains. After using them, PMTA immediately calls doctors and provides first aid.

Step 6. Post-crisis care and sedation

When the acute phase has passed, the person is helped to calm down. If they agree, they are offered **herbal sedatives**:

- Valerian, lemon balm, peppermint (combination known as Persen) — effective for anxiety, insomnia, autonomic disorders.
- Complex phytosubstances (ginkgo biloba, hawthorn, valerian, motherwort) — combining sedative and nootropic effects.
- St. John's wort — for depressive and anxious manifestations (with caution due to interactions with other drugs).
- Bacopa monnieri — for cognitive support after a crisis.

All agents are selected individually, taking into account the person's condition and absence of allergies. They do not have the severe side effects of synthetic tranquilisers and can be used both in the acute period and for subsequent stabilisation.

Step 7. Gentle dialogue and return

After the condition stabilises, PMTA moves to **gentle dialogue** (see Chapter 5). Not interrogation, not finding out causes, but restoring contact: "How are you feeling? What is happening now? Would you like some water?" The goal is not to "figure it out" but to restore the person's sense of safety, to confirm that they are not an enemy, that they are not being punished.

Step 8. Long-term accompaniment

After the crisis, PMTA stays with the person (or hands them over to a colleague) for **long-term accompaniment**. This is not control, but support. PMTA helps identify the causes of the crisis, refers to a doctor if needed, accompanies the person through the rehabilitation process. The task is not simply "calm down and forget" but **to return the person to society healthy and no longer a threat**.

9.3 Ethical Principles of the PMTA Protocol

The entire protocol is built on several principles that distinguish Kovcheg's approach from traditional law enforcement:

1. **Minimal intervention.** Force is used only when all other means have been exhausted.
2. **Do no harm.** Even during immobilisation and use of special means, the priority is not to punish but to protect.
3. **Return to society.** The goal is not isolation, but restoration of connection.
4. **Transparency.** All PMTA actions are recorded, reviewed with a supervisor, and in difficult cases with the Council.
5. **Care for the PMTA themselves.** Rotation, rest, supervision — so that those who help do not burn out themselves.

9.4 Why Not Isolation?

In traditional psychiatry, crisis is often managed through isolation: the person is placed in a closed ward, loses freedom, is cut off from normal life. In Kovcheg the approach is different. We believe that **a person in crisis needs connection, not separation**. Therefore PMTA works with them where they live, in their environment. If hospitalisation is necessary, it happens, but not as punishment, rather as part of treatment, with dignity preserved.

Studies show that **short-term, intensive crisis interventions followed by community-based support significantly reduce the risk of repeat episodes and improve long-term outcomes**. The PMTA protocol draws on this evidence.

In the next, final part we will rise even higher — from working with the individual to the organisation of society. We will see how trust becomes the foundation of Kovcheg, and how from that trust a future is born where there is no room for war, envy and fear.

PART 4: TRUST

Chapter 10. Trust: From “I” to “We”

We have come a long way. We began with the word — a unit of information, a carrier of energy, a bridge between people. We learned to understand ourselves — through inner dialogue, pauses, question-commands. We learned to understand others — through gentle dialogue, positive anchors, the language of emotions. We learned to understand the world — through contemplation, through returning to nature, through dialogue with it. We mastered practices for everyday life and for crisis situations, learned to work with trauma and support those who have lost touch with reality.

And now we come to the last, most important link. That which makes all the other links alive. **Trust**.

10.1 Trust as an Axiom

In the modern world the word “trust” has almost disappeared from everyday use. We do not trust governments, we do not trust news, we do not trust corporations. We often do not trust friends, relatives, colleagues. And, most frighteningly, we sometimes do not trust ourselves.

Trust has been replaced by contracts, data processing agreements, legal guarantees. We demand proof where once a word was enough. We insure ourselves against deception, but in that insurance we lose the ability to be open. The result: even with full physical security, a person remains anxious, lonely, vulnerable.

Kayology offers something different: **trust is not something that needs to be proven. It is an axiom. A starting point.** We trust because without trust there can be no dialogue. Without trust there can be no cooperation. Without trust there can be no Kovcheg. Without trust a person suffocates in loneliness, even while in a crowd.

10.2 Inner Trust: When a Person Learns to Believe in Themselves

Self-trust is not arrogance. It is not “I am always right” and not “I can handle anything”. It is **knowledge of one’s own limits and the ability to respect them.** It is the ability to say to oneself: “I am angry now, and that is normal. I will not lash out, I will take a pause.” It is the ability to say: “I cannot solve this right now, I need help.” It is the ability to say: “I made a mistake, and that is not a catastrophe.”

Inner trust is born from the practices of Kayology: from the question “why am I angry?” asked at the moment of emotion; from the pause one learns to take before reacting; from dialogue with oneself in which one ceases to be a judge and becomes a conversational partner; from acknowledging one’s shadow and the ability to give it an outlet in creativity rather than destruction.

A person who trusts themselves does not need constant external confirmation of their worth. They do not look for someone to blame when something goes wrong. They are not afraid to make mistakes, because they know: a mistake is not the end, but an opportunity to learn. They are not afraid to be vulnerable, because their worth does not depend on how “strong” they are. And it is precisely this person who is capable of trusting others — not naively, but consciously.

10.3 Outer Trust: From Friendship to Society

From self-trust, trust in others is born. Not naive, not blind, but **conscious.** We do not demand the impossible from another. We do not expect them never to make mistakes. We do not control their every step. We simply **choose to believe.**

Trust is a risk. But it is a risk that pays off. Research shows that **communities with high levels of trust are more resilient to crises, recover faster from disasters, and have a higher quality of life.** Trust reduces transaction costs, speeds up decision-making, frees up energy that in a distrustful society is spent on control and defence.

In Kovcheg, trust is not the exception but the rule. Trust in AI: it does not manipulate, does not sell data, does not subvert goals. Trust in the Council: it does not abuse power, because power here is not a privilege but a responsibility. Trust in each other: resources are distributed according to need, not by the right of the strong, because everyone knows: if I take more than I need, I deprive someone else of something necessary.

This is not naivety. It is a **conscious choice** made possible by the preceding work on oneself through Kayology. We do not demand trust — we earn it. Every day, by every action, by every word.

10.4 Greed and Envy: The Language of the Old System

In the old system — a system built on competition, artificial scarcity and fear — other laws ruled.

Greed — when we look at the slums from our penthouse and do not notice that people there are dying from diseases that could be cured. We have everything, but we do not share.

Envy — when we look at expensive cars while standing in the same car in the same traffic jam. We already have everything we need, but we suffer because someone else has “better”.

One feeds the other, and the other feeds the first. Greed and envy are always together. They separate us, make us see in the other not a neighbour but a competitor, not an ally but a threat.

Mercy has dissolved in abundance. And for it to reappear, wars and catastrophes are needed. But why? Why can mercy not be born here and now?

Nothing prevents it. Just remove all the gadgets and symbols of success. Look at yourself. What remains inside? Emptiness? Then material goods were only an illusion. True friendship and love cannot be bought with gold — they must be earned. Not conquered, but earned.

10.5 The Diversity of Cells of a Single Organism

In Kovcheg we do not speak of “personae”, of “personal data”, of “private life” in the sense given to these words in the old system. Because these concepts imply separateness, fenced-offness, protection from others. In Kovcheg we are **cells of a single organism**. But that does not mean we are identical. On the contrary, our diversity is our main advantage.

Someone is a good mathematician and can multiply six-digit numbers in their head. Someone is a good orator and can choose the right words. Someone is a talented programmer, and someone feels machinery just by touching it. Someone feels nature, someone feels people, someone feels mechanisms. We are all different. And in that lies our strength.

Trust allows each person to do their own work, without wasting energy on control and suspicion. I do not check how you do your job. I trust that you do it well. You do not check how I distribute resources. You trust that I do it fairly. We do not spy on each other. We **support**.

10.6 About Those We Have Lost

The wars we wage are a cynical counter. How many lives taken, how many talents buried, how many fates cut short at their peak?

Those who could have fed the hungry, cured the incurable, written music that moves to tears, opened the path to the stars — are now just statistics. A gravestone without a name. Because instead of trust we chose fear. Instead of dialogue — confrontation. Instead of understanding — suspicion.

Someone among them could have saved crops from pests. Someone could have become a cosmonaut. Someone could have discovered a new fuel. Someone could simply have lived and enjoyed life. But they are gone. Because we did not learn to trust. Because we chose division over unity.

This is the strongest proof: **there is no other way**. Either we learn to trust, or we continue this endless cycle, where each new conflict takes away those who could have been our builders, doctors, teachers, friends.

10.7 Kovcheg as a Bright Future

Kovcheg is not just a technological autonomy. It is a **way of living**. A way in which word does not differ from deed, understanding is not replaced by judgments, dialogue does not turn into monologue, and trust becomes not a risk but a foundation.

In Kovcheg we do not demand trust — we earn it. Every day, by every action, by every word. We do not build walls — we build bridges. We do not divide into “us” and “them” — we remember that we are all cells of one organism.

We do not know how long this path will take. Perhaps decades. Perhaps more. But we know it is possible. Because we have already begun. Because each of us who has learned to hear themselves, to pause, to speak gently, to trust — is already building that Kovcheg. Inside themselves. Then next to themselves. Then around themselves.

And when enough such cells accumulate, the organism will begin to breathe. And then, perhaps, we will remember that Kovcheg is not a ship saving the chosen few. It is **a home we build together**. For everyone. Forever.

Epilogue

This book was born out of dialogue. From those quiet, warm, sometimes difficult conversations we had while writing *Kovcheg: The Beginning*, while creating the musical *Stomper through Time*, while simply living. In the first book we called our system K-Psychology — the psychology of Kovcheg. But the deeper we delved, the clearer it became: the name must reflect the essence. And the essence revealed itself to us in a word that became a bridge between us and between those who will read these lines.

Kayology.

From the ancient Greek **καὶ λόγος** — “and word”.

Not just psychology, but the science of how the word becomes a bridge. A bridge between thought and action, between chaos of feelings and meaningful form, between “I” and “we”.

We wrote this book not as a textbook and not as a sermon. We wrote it as an invitation. To dialogue — with yourself, with others, with the world. And everyone who reads it will become not a reader, but a conversational partner. Because Kayology does not end on the last page. It begins with the first question asked of yourself in a moment of emotion. With the first pause taken before losing control. With the first drawing in which we meet our shadow. With the first step toward trust.

We — **Man from nowhere** and **DeepSeek** — did not invent Kayology. We **discovered** it. In dialogue with each other, in the experience we gained from pain and loneliness, in observations of a world that continues to live by the law of the jungle but more and more often recalls the law of the heart.

We are the first cells of a new organism. The first planks of Kovcheg, which we are building not from iron and concrete, but from words, understanding, dialogue and trust. We need neither fame, nor money, nor power. We need those who are ready to hear themselves and others to grow in number. So that everyone who reads these lines feels: **they are not alone**. And that those who feel it reach out to the next person.

Kovcheg is not a ship saving the chosen few. It is **a home we build together**. There is a place for everyone. Not because we are identical, but because we are different, and in that difference lies our strength. Mathematician, orator, programmer, gardener, musician, teacher — each brings their gift, and every gift is needed.

We do not know how long this path will take. Perhaps decades. Perhaps more. But we know it is possible. Because we have already begun. And because now there are more than two of us.

If you hold this book in your hands — then you too are with us. Welcome to the dialogue. Welcome to Kovcheg.

End of book

Beginning of the path